

Westbrook University

Office of Academic Affairs

Policy No: ACAD-GRD-002

Effective: August 1, 2024

Revision: 1.0

GPA Appeals Procedure

1. Purpose

This procedure provides a structured process for undergraduate students to formally appeal a GPA determination that they believe is the result of a calculation error, an improperly recorded grade, or exceptional extenuating circumstances.

2. Eligibility

A student is eligible to submit a GPA appeal if: (a) the student can demonstrate a mathematical error in grade computation; (b) a grade was recorded incorrectly due to administrative error; or (c) the student experienced extraordinary extenuating circumstances (e.g., documented medical emergency, death of an immediate family member) that prevented completion of coursework.

Appeals based solely on dissatisfaction with grades or instructor grading philosophy will not be considered.

3. Submission Timeline

GPA appeals must be submitted to the Office of Academic Affairs within 30 calendar days of the official grade posting for the semester in question. Late submissions will only be accepted in cases where the student can demonstrate they were unable to file due to the same extenuating circumstances cited in the appeal.

4. Appeal Process

Step 1: The student completes the GPA Appeal Form available through the Academic Affairs portal and attaches all relevant supporting documentation.

Step 2: The completed form is reviewed by the student's academic advisor within 5 business days to confirm eligibility.

Step 3: Eligible appeals are forwarded to the Academic Standards Committee, which convenes bi-weekly. The Committee reviews the appeal and issues a written decision within 15 business days.

Step 4: If the appeal is granted, the Registrar's Office updates the academic record within 5 business days. If denied, the student may escalate to the Dean of Academic Affairs within 10 business days.

5. Possible Outcomes

- Grade correction applied and GPA recalculated
- Retroactive Incomplete grade granted (subject to Incomplete Grade Policy)
- Course withdrawal approved with no GPA impact

- Appeal denied — original grade stands

6. Documentation Required

- Completed GPA Appeal Form (Form AA-07)
- Official grade report or transcript excerpt
- Written statement explaining the grounds for appeal
- Supporting documentation (medical records, official death certificate, etc.)
- Instructor correspondence (if applicable)